



Ing. Dr. Elvis Twumasi
Lecturer, Department of Electrical and Electronic Engineering
KNUST, Kumasi
Assist. Power Systems Lead, KNUST Engineering Education Programme

Tel: +233-248656932
Email: etwumasi.coe@knust.edu.gh

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TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

Dear Sir/Madam,

LETTER OF RECOMMENDATION FOR MR. OGHENEFEGOR FAVOUR UGBINE

I am pleased to recommend Mr Oghenefegor Favour Ugbine for industrial and research opportunities, most especially in energy, sustainability, and applied AI. I have worked with Oghenefegor closely in my capacity as his coach and mentor during his role as an Artificial Intelligence in Energy Fellow at the Africa Sustainable Energy Centre (ASEC). In this time, he has stood out as a rare blend of intellectual depth, execution strength, and mission-driven focus. He is the kind of person I would describe as a pathfinder: someone who not only learn systems but also builds them, improves them, and helps others understand them.

At ASEC, Oghenefegor has been a strong contributor to one of our most important initiatives: building a specialist AI assistant focused only on energy systems and sustainable growth, with an emphasis on Africa-focused context. The goal is to move beyond a general-purpose chatbot and develop a domain-specific “energy expert” assistant powered by a retrieval-based approach, so responses are grounded in real policy documents, reports, and trusted references. Oghenefegor has approached this work with impressive clarity. He quickly understood the logic of the pipeline, from identifying relevant data sources to structuring documents for retrieval, to thinking through how a user’s question should return a precise answer supported by evidence.

What makes him exceptional is how he thinks. Oghenefegor does not just accept ideas at the surface level. He naturally asks the deeper questions: What problem are we solving? What assumptions are we making? What could fail in real use? How do we measure quality? In our discussions, he consistently pushes the work from “good concept” to “buildable system,” and he does this without needing to be micromanaged. His learning speed is high, but more importantly, his learning is structured. He studies, summarises, tests his understanding, and then turns it into a clear plan of action.

He also brings a strong technical foundation that supports this role. Oghenefegor has advanced training in computational modelling and scientific programming, with proven experience building structured workflows and solving optimisation problems. This matters because applied AI systems require discipline: clear inputs, clear outputs, and consistent validation. In this sense, he brings the mindset of an engineer who understands that reliability and evaluation are not optional.

Beyond ASEC, Oghenefegor has demonstrated excellence in high-expectation environments. He holds an Erasmus Mundus Joint M.Sc. degree, and He was selected as a Top 5 finalist in the Sanofi Device Innovation Challenge, which highlights his ability to perform under pressure, collaborate across disciplines, and deliver strong outcomes within strict timelines. His research profile is also strong, supported by multiple publications and a track record of continuous professional upskilling.

In summary, Oghenefegor is diligent, intellectually sharp, and unusually consistent in execution. He combines technical ability with purpose, and he is strongly aligned with real-world impact in energy and sustainability. I recommend him with confidence for roles, fellowships, or graduate opportunities where he can apply AI to energy systems, build practical tools, and contribute meaningfully to sustainable growth.

Please feel free to contact me if you would like any additional information.

Yours faithfully,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Elvis Twumasi', with a stylized flourish at the end.

Dr. Elvis Twumasi